

```
$attach->binmode;
local $/;
<$attach>
}
```

Ensure that you use the right command for the right content transfer encoding. Whichever line comes before the *uencode* or *base64* command, it must have two new lines before it, to process the mail properly. In Shell, by default, *echo* comes with a new line. Adding '-e' option and '\n' would make that two new lines.

The *Content Type* can be figured out using the *file* command in Linux. But in other UNIX platforms, the *file* command doesn't have that feature. Keeping it as 'octet-stream' handles any kind of file. By default, when we attach any file, the normal *mail* command takes the default as octet-stream, except for plain text files.

HTML email

We have so far handled only plain text mails. And if we receive text mails in Outlook or any other mail client, when we try to reply, it (by default) sticks to the non-HTML environment in which it was initially received. Only in HTML format can we highlight or beautify the text if we need to forward a text mail to someone. To do that, we have to manually change the property of the mail from text to HTML. Instead, we can also make the machine send an HTML mail rather than a text mail.

We can also add different kinds of HTML entries, like tables, URLs or any form of coloured mail, even using style sheets. The presentation always matters.

The following code will send HTML mails. I'm not covering HTML with attachments. If you want to add attachments, the earlier attachment methods could be used (plain text or application/octet-stream and encoding standards to be base64 or normal 7-bit).

For Shell, the code is:

```
#!/bin/bash

subject="Bash HTML";
from="osfyuser";
to="osfyedit";
url='http://localhost/css/mail.css';
#css='location/to/css/file' # If we are using a local
stylesheet, then 'cat $css' into the body
css='mail.css' # If we are using a local file, then cat $css
into the body
'wget -q0- $url > $css';
bodyFile="mailbody.html";

cat > $bodyFile <<EOF
<!doctype html public "-//w3c//dtd html 4.0 transitional//
en">
```

```
<html>
<head><style>
'cat $css'
</style></head>
```

```
<p>this is test mail<br>
```

```
<table id='mail'><tr><th>Month</th><th>Savings</th></tr><tr>
<td>January</td><td>$100</td></tr>
<tr class='alt'><td>February</td><td>$500</td></tr></table>
</html>
EOF
```

```
{
echo "From: $from"
echo "To: $to"
echo "Subject: $subject"
echo -e "Content-Type: text/html; charset=us-ascii\n";
cat $bodyFile
echo
} | /usr/sbin/sendmail -t
```

For Perl, the code is:

```
#!/usr/local/bin/perl
use LWP::Simple qw(get);

my ($url, @css, $subject, $from, $to, $fh, $content);
$subject = "Perl HTML";
$from="osfyuser";
$to="osfyedit";
$fh="mailbody.html";
$url = 'http://localhost/css/mail.css'; @css = get $url;
#@css='cat $css';

my $message=<<EOF;
<!doctype html public "-//w3c//dtd html 4.0 transitional//
en">
<\html>\n
<\head>\n<style>\n
@css
</style></head>\n\n
<p>this is test mail\n\n
<table id='mail'>\n<tr>\n<th>Month</th>\n<th>Savings</th></tr>
<tr>\n<tr>\n
<td>January</td>\n<td>$100</td></tr>\n<tr class='alt'>\n
<td>February</td>\n<td>$500</td></tr></table>\n
</html>\n
EOF

open(FILE, ">", "$fh") or die "Cannot open $fh: $!";
print FILE $message;
close(FILE);
```